

TAB 27



Board of Education Report

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Agenda Date: 4/21/2026

In Control: Board of Education

Dr. Rivas - Recognizing Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Relatives Awareness Day and Advancing Education, Safety, and Justice for Indigenous Communities (Res-057-25/26) (Waiver of Board Rule 72)

Whereas, Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Relatives (MMIWR) represents a longstanding and ongoing human rights crisis in the United States, disproportionately impacting Indigenous women, girls, and relatives and devastating families, Tribal Nations, and communities;

Whereas, Indigenous women, girls, and relatives experience disproportionately high rates of violence, disappearance, and homicide, and this crisis continues to impact Native families and Tribal communities across the United States;

Whereas, Data from federal agencies indicates that more than four in five American Indian and Alaska Native women have experienced violence in their lifetime, and Native women face significantly elevated rates of homicide compared to other groups;

Whereas, The MMIWR crisis is linked to systemic inequities, including jurisdictional limitations, gaps in coordination across law enforcement systems, underreporting, and historical and ongoing harms affecting Indigenous communities; including limitations on Tribal authority to prosecute certain crimes that have contributed to gaps in accountability and safety;

Whereas, Native families, Tribal Nations, and advocacy organizations have led efforts to raise awareness, support impacted families, and advance policies that promote prevention, accountability, and justice;

Whereas, May 5 is recognized nationally as Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Relatives Awareness Day, honoring the life of Hanna Harris and all Indigenous women, girls, and relatives who are missing or have been lost to violence, and serving as a day of remembrance, visibility, and action;

Whereas, California is home to one of the largest Native populations in the United States and has taken steps to address this crisis, including the establishment of the Feather Alert program to support the recovery of missing Indigenous persons;

Whereas, Public education systems play a critical role in fostering awareness, respect, and understanding of Indigenous histories, cultures, and contemporary issues, and in preparing students to engage thoughtfully and responsibly in addressing real-world challenges;

Whereas, Educational resources developed to address the Missing and Murdered Indigenous Peoples crisis emphasize the importance of trauma-informed, culturally responsive approaches, including ensuring access to mental health supports, engaging trusted adults and community members, and

creating safe spaces for students to learn and process difficult topics;

Whereas, These educational approaches highlight that awareness efforts should not only inform students about the crisis, but also equip them with knowledge, self-awareness, and strategies to keep themselves and others safe, while fostering empathy, respect, and community responsibility;

Whereas, The Los Angeles Unified School District (District) serves students and families across diverse communities, including Indigenous students and families, and has a responsibility to ensure that all students learn in environments that affirm their identities, histories, and lived experiences, while also providing safe, supportive, and trauma-informed learning conditions; and

Whereas, The District has previously taken action to recognize and uplift Indigenous communities, including through the adoption of “Reckoning with Our Past, Honoring Our Present: Developing a Los Angeles Unified Land Acknowledgement” (Res-017-24/25), and through the ongoing work of the Multilingual and Multicultural Education Department to advance Indigenous tribes recognition, culturally responsive curriculum, and professional development for educators that centers Indigenous histories, perspectives, and lived experiences; now, therefore, be it

Resolved, That the Governing Board of the Los Angeles Unified School District (Board) recognizes May 5, 2026, and every year thereafter, as Missing and Murdered Indigenous Women and Relatives (MMIWR) Awareness Day, and encourages school communities to participate in age-appropriate awareness efforts that honor Indigenous women, girls, and relatives;

Resolved further, That the Board affirms its solidarity with Indigenous families, Tribal Nations, and advocacy organizations, and recognizes the importance of centering impacted families and respecting Tribal sovereignty in efforts to address the MMIWR crisis;

Resolved further, That the Board directs the Superintendent or designee to identify opportunities to share culturally respectful, age-appropriate, and trauma-informed educational resources with students and staff that raise awareness about MMIWR and Indigenous communities;

Resolved further, That the Board directs the Superintendent or designee to ensure that any instructional or awareness efforts related to MMIWR are implemented using trauma-informed, culturally responsive practices that prioritize student well-being, including access to appropriate supports and safeguards when engaging with sensitive content;

Resolved further, That the Board directs the Superintendent to promote awareness of the California Feather Alert program, including sharing information with school communities about its purpose and role in supporting the safe recovery of missing Indigenous community members;

Resolved further, That the Board encourages partnerships with Native-led organizations and community partners to support advocacy, visibility, and community-informed efforts that advance justice and safety for Indigenous women, girls, and relatives; and, be it finally

Resolved, That the Board directs the Superintendent and the District’s Office of Government Relations to advocate to the California State Legislature and the Governor for continued and strengthened policies, funding, and coordinated efforts to prevent and respond to Missing and Murdered Indigenous

Women and Relatives, improve data collection and reporting, and support Indigenous families and communities impacted by this crisis.